Phishing Awareness Training

Recognizing and Preventing Phishing Attacks

Cybersecurity Awareness Project

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Outline

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Introduction
Phishing

- Phishing is a cyber attack in which criminals pretend to be trusted people or organizations to trick victims into revealing sensitive information.
- They want your passwords, bank financial information, personal information, access to account and computer system.
- Phishing can happen through emails, text messages, phone call, and social media.

Type of Phishing

- Email phishing: fake emails designed to steal information.
- Smishing: phishing messages sent through SMS or text messages.
- Vishing: Fraudulent phone call used to trick the victims.
- Spear phishing: messages targeted at a specific person or organization.
- Clone phishing: A fake copy of a genuine message containing a suspicious link or attachment.

Common Red Flags

- Unusual messages: unexpected spelling mistakes, strange wording, or request that don’t make sense.
- Requests for sensitive information: someone ask for your password, bank details, or verification code.
- Unexpected attachments: files arrive from unknown senders.
- Strange links: the link address does not match the official website
- Urgent messages: “your account will be closed immediately!”
- Suspicious senders: the email address or phone looks unfamiliar.

- How to Spot a Fake Website

Example of Phishing

- * Check the domain name: Attackers may use misspelled versions of legitimate websites.
- * Inspect links carefully: On a computer, hover over a link to preview its destination before clicking.
- * Look for HTTPS: HTTPS encrypts the connection, but it does not guarantee that a website is legitimate.
- * Watch for pressure tactics: Fake websites may claim your account will be suspended unless you act immediately.
- * Avoid unexpected downloads: Do not download files from untrusted websites.
- * Verify the website: Open the organization’s official website directly instead of using a link in a suspicious message.
- Example
- Suspicious: paypaI-example.com
- The letter “I” in this example could be mistaken for a lowercase “l”.
- Safety Tip: Never enter your password or banking information on a website you have not verified.

Social Engineering tactics

Common Tactics

* Fear: Threatening to suspend an account.

* Urgency: Demanding immediate action.

* Impersonation: Pretending to be a bank employee, boss, or IT support worker.

* Rewards: Offering fake prizes or gifts.

* Curiosity: Using tempting messages or unexpected attachments.

Example Scenario

You receive an email claiming that your bank account will be blocked in 10 minutes unless you click a link and verify your password.

What should you do?

Best Practices for Staying Safe Online

How to Protect Yourself from Phishing

* Verify the sender: Confirm unexpected requests through a trusted channel.

* Think before clicking: Check links and attachments before opening them.

* Use strong passwords: Create unique passwords for each account.

* Enable multi-factor authentication (MFA): Add another layer of account protection.

* Update your devices: Install security updates for your operating system, browser, and applications.

* Use security software: Keep reputable antivirus and security tools updated.

* Protect personal information: Never share passwords, PINS, or verification codes with untrusted people.

* Report suspicious messages: Notify your IT or security team when appropriate.

Steps to Take

What to Do if You Receive a Phishing Message

1. Do not click: Avoid suspicious links and attachments.

2. Do not reply: Don’t respond to suspicious messages or share personal information.

3. Verify the message: Contact the supposed sender through a trusted channel.

4. Report it: Use your email provider’s phishing-report option or notify your organization’s IT/security team.

5. Delete or quarantine it: Follow your organization’s reporting procedure before removing the message.

6. If you clicked a link: Stop interacting with the website and report the incident.

7. If you shared your password: Change it immediately using the official website and enable MFA. Change it anywhere else you reused it.

8. If you shared financial details: Contact your bank immediately.

Phishing Scenario

“Your company account will be disabled today. Click the link below to verify your password immediately.”

Warning Signs

* The message creates a sense of urgency.

* It requests a password through a link.

* The sender’s identity has not been verified.

* The link may lead to a fake login page.

Discussion Questions

1. What signs suggest this email could be phishing?

Remember These Cybersecurity Rules

Key Takeaways

* Recognize suspicious emails, links, and attachments.

* Verify the sender before trusting a message.

* Never share passwords, PINS or verification codes.

* Use strong, unique passwords and enable MFA.

* Report suspicious messages to the appropriate team.

* Act quickly if you accidentally share sensitive information.

The Golden Rule

STOP. THINK. VERIFY. REPORT.

Stay Alert. Stay Secure.

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